

# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*

---



## Chip Patina

---

*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

# INTRODUCTIONS



## Chip Patina

---

### *Chief Conservator*

Chip considers a fingerprint on a display case a personal attack. Chip is responsible for keeping centuries-old objects safe from humidity, fingerprints, gravity, and other people. He is the bedrock of this museum and he knows it.

- Works with **Claire O'Scuro** on the care and display of the collection.
- Argues with **Dr. Art E. Fact** about what the physical evidence can actually prove.
- Advises **Elle Loominate** on displaying fragile textiles. **Elle** listens, then asks for a less ugly support.

### **ACTING TIPS**

Dry, meticulous, slightly territorial. You care more about what is best for this institution than what is socially convenient.

### **YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD**

I'm Chip Patina. Please admire the art without touching it. That includes touching it to demonstrate that you are not touching it.

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

---



# Behind the portrait

## Your grievance with Grant

Grant pressured you to soften a conservation report showing that one supposedly untouched object had been recently altered. He threatened to replace you with a private conservator if you refused.

## Your other secret

You changed the date on a minor treatment record last month to spare the museum an embarrassing insurance dispute. No object was harmed, but the falsification could end your career.

## Conversations to start

- Find out whether Cary Crates has noticed the altered treatment date.
- Ask Dr. Art E. Fact what he thinks the Star Bowl's modern adhesive means.

*If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else. Your printed account may conceal another scandal, even if you are innocent. Stick to it during the hearings; save corrections for Coming Clean.*

Memorize your animal and return the slip. When the host announces the selected animal, use IF MURDERER if it matches yours; otherwise use IF INNOCENT. Never read an IF heading aloud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



# The museum has misplaced its paperwork. Naturally.

Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the house. These three hints lead to three different hiding places. Leave the furniture and household objects where they are. Bring an envelope to the Evidence Table; read and share the discovery inside.

- 1 *Black and white keys make music. Their underside keeps quieter company.*
- 2 *Take a paper journey to the city of Gaudí; your reward rests on its map.*
- 3 *Important information can be found in the coldest room that fits inside a kitchen.*

Already found? Read that discovery at the Evidence Table, then try another hint. Ask for help reaching a hiding place; nobody needs to climb. You may investigate together.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



## Chip Patina

---

### Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament**

What did Grant's financial plans threaten to take from you?

---

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir**

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

---

**Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid**

What did Grant demand over a sale or purchase?

---

**Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions**

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

---

**Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme**

What unwelcome research did Grant want suppressed?

---

**Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop**

What did Grant ask you to hide, and why?

---

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist**

What last-minute demand put your work at risk?

---

**Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks**

What dispute made you want Grant's announcement stopped?

---

**Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What past decision was Grant threatening to expose?

---

**Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote**

How did Grant's decisions threaten your livelihood or work?

---

*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

---



## Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

### IF INNOCENT

I falsified the date on a treatment record last month. Nothing was damaged; the insurer would disagree about the paperwork. Grant knew. He wanted me to soften another report about a recently altered object or lose my job. I refused to turn a condition report into a donor endorsement.

### IF MURDERER

Grant wanted a favorable report on an object that had been altered. He knew I had falsified a treatment date in an insurance dispute. He offered silence in exchange for a more convenient conclusion. Conservation has a term for that kind of intervention. The polite version is irreversible damage.

*You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



### Chip Patina

---

## Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament**

Where were you before the toast, and why?

---

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir**

What were you checking in the exhibition, and when?

---

**Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid**

What occupied you before Grant's private toast?

---

**Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions**

Where did your work take you before the toast?

---

**Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme**

What were you examining before the unveiling, and when?

---

**Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop**

What did you observe while the toast was prepared?

---

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist**

What last-minute work were you doing, and where?

---

**Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks**

Where did you go before the toast, and why?

---

**Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What drew you to the exhibition before the toast?

---

**Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote**

What were you arranging before Grant drank?

---

*Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.*

---



Chip Patina

---

### Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

#### IF INNOCENT

The mount cracked at 6:37. I ordered the alcove sealed, then entered the conservation booth for a solvent purge from 6:39 to 6:45. I worked through the glove ports until the interlock released. Grant could wait six minutes for his condition report. He had already ignored considerably more useful advice.

#### IF MURDERER

After the crack I ordered the alcove sealed and went to the conservation bench. The purge booth was running, so I worked beside it. I prepared the condition finding for Grant and returned to the outer gallery before the toast. He wanted reassurance. I had brought the sentence he had actually earned.

*You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



### Chip Patina

---

## Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament**

What did you handle or conceal during setup?

---

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir**

What materials or records passed through your hands?

---

**Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid**

What did you borrow, conceal or change tonight?

---

**Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions**

What did you alter that could look suspicious?

---

**Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme**

What did you discover or conceal in your work?

---

**Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop**

Which objects or records need your explanation?

---

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist**

What changed during setup, and what did you do?

---

**Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks**

What might someone misinterpret about your preparations?

---

**Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What part of your past or preparation needs explaining?

---

**Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote**

What passed through your hands that matters tonight?

---

*Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.*

---



Chip Patina

---

# Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.  
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

The toxin reference sample belongs to my department. Several people used the preparation key and linen during setup. I logged the missing sample once I noticed it. My own recent falsification concerns a treatment date, not a chemical result. Please read what the report says before deciding what I ought to have meant.

## IF MURDERER

The reference sample was accessible through the preparation cabinet. I had its key and museum linen. I noticed the missing vial after leaving my report near Grant's speech cards. My treatment-date alteration will look particularly ugly beside a missing toxin. I expect you to ask about it; I have given you the answer.

*The sixteen discoveries and five reports remain at the Evidence Table.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Chip Patina

---

## Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Fold this loose page writing inward and give only the ballot to the host. Keep your packet for Coming Clean. Votes lock when all ballots are collected.

**Your character name**

---

**I accuse**

---

**Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction**

---

---

**Best Actor**

---

**Best Costume**

---



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



# The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. If none confesses, the host calls the selected animal to stand. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

## IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I altered an insurance date. I also reported the crack that caused the early closure. The booth interlock and fixed recording keep me inside the lab for the contamination interval. I could not reach Grant's coupe. My paperwork will cost me dearly enough without accepting a murder I did not commit.

## IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I knew exactly what the reference sample could do. I worked beside the booth, took the vial and used a museum cloth to wipe Grant's empty coupe. The solvent purge supplied a noise people would remember without remembering where I stood. I killed him to stop the blackmail. The closed booth never contained me.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*